



Elevator pitch

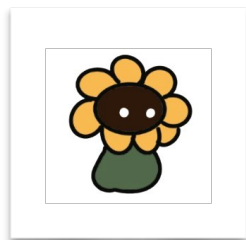
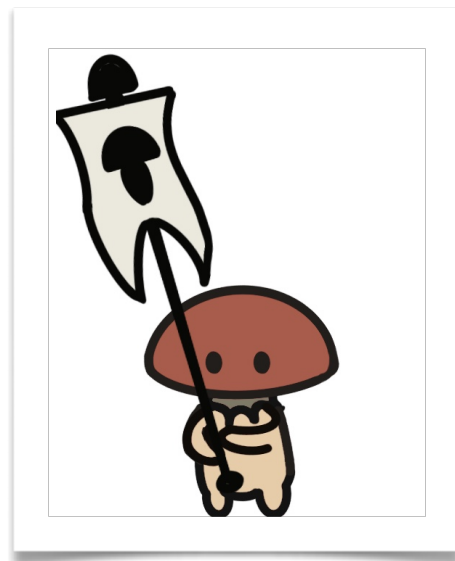
Grow, harvest, and command your troop of tiny mushrooms in this auto-battler with RPG elements. Master the mycelial lifecycle and create powerful lineages with mutations and fertilisers. Adapt by changing your formation and weapons. All biomass will be assimilated.

Key information

Platform	Steam (Windows, Mac)
Player count	Singleplayer
Genre	Auto-battler, strategy, roguelike, indie
Planned release	Summer 2027
Monetisation	Premium, CHF 14.–
Estimated playtime	30–60 minutes per run. Built for replay: lineages, mutations, seals, and enemy variety.
Game engine	Godot 4.7

Unique selling points

- **A lineage auto-battler.** You grow, mutate, compost, and re-plant a bloodline across a run. You do not draft a units from a shop. This promotes emotional attachment to your units and emergent story-telling.
- **Time and power tradeoffs.** Stronger units take longer to grow, weaker ones are immediately available
- **A mushroom themed game.** Biomass, spores, fertilisers, and mutations create the identity of the game rooted in the world of fungi.
- **Cute-dark and handmade.** Eclectic illustration, tiny units, physics fights that are satisfying to watch.



People involved

The project is submitted by **Blobfish Games GmbH** (Zürich). *Auto Shrooms* is developed by **Pedro Caldeira**, with environment art by **Stephanie Stutz**. **Thomas Gervraud** (founder of Blobfish) mentors the project and hosts it at the studio. A co-ownership agreement between Pedro Caldeira and Blobfish Games GmbH is part of the attachments of the dossier.



Pedro Caldeira

A Software Engineer with an EPFL degree in Computer Science, he left the world of fintechs to follow his dream of making games. *Auto Shrooms* is his second commercial project, he released his first game, *wageslave*, on June 2026.

Roles: design, code, character art

Portfolio: <https://cauldron.games>



Stephanie Stutz

Art lead on *The Wandering Village*. She worked on multiple projects as an artist at *Stray Fawn Studio*. She is working on *Auto Shrooms* as an environment and background artist.

Roles: environment art, backgrounds

Portfolio: <https://www.behance.net/StephanieStutzArt>



Thomas Gervraud — Studio Head / mentor

Founder of Blobfish Games GmbH. Creator of *Brotato*. Mentor at the Swiss Game Hub bootcamp. He is lending his expertise on this project for production and game design advice as well as studio hosting.

Project status

A playable prototype of the full 10-day loop already exists: Custom unit art and a first pass of the hub are in. The project already has a [Steam Page](#).

Pedro took part in the [Swiss Game Hub bootcamp 2026](#) (26 June – 14 August), mentored by Thomas Gervaud (Blobfish Games), Philomena Schwab (Stray Fawn Studio), and Maxim Munnig (Flying Squirrel Entertainment), all three veterans of the industry. The bootcamp put particular emphasis on genre selection, scope, and commercial positioning. Auto Shrooms was developed following the principles and feedback from the bootcamp.

Next goal of pre-production: a polished vertical slice published as a free Steam demo, with the demo reception serving as a validation of the concept. Pro Helvetia funds will directly serve this goal.

Design pillars

Auto Battler

Player choices are done in between battles. Battles serve as a test for the player's strategy.

Lineage over loot

Unit power comes from mutations, fertilisers, and training, not from the game shop.

Time–power tradeoffs

Dilemmas between immediately usable units or investing power for later.

Cute/dark aesthetic

Tiny mushrooms fighting in a garden war. Some darker lore that is not visible at first sight.



Core gameplay loop

Nursery: Grow your Units



Plant a spore on a plot. Wait for it to grow. Apply fertilisers to change growth mechanics and mutations. Harvest a Child. Compost an Adult to recover a lineage spore that carries trainings and mutations into the next generation.

War Chamber: Arrange your squad

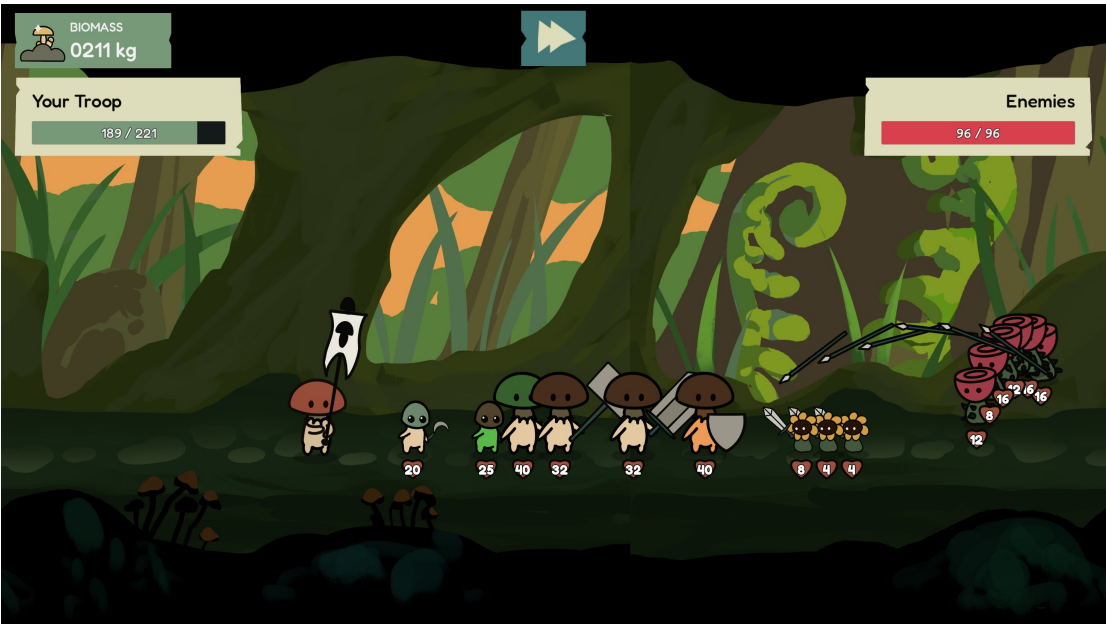
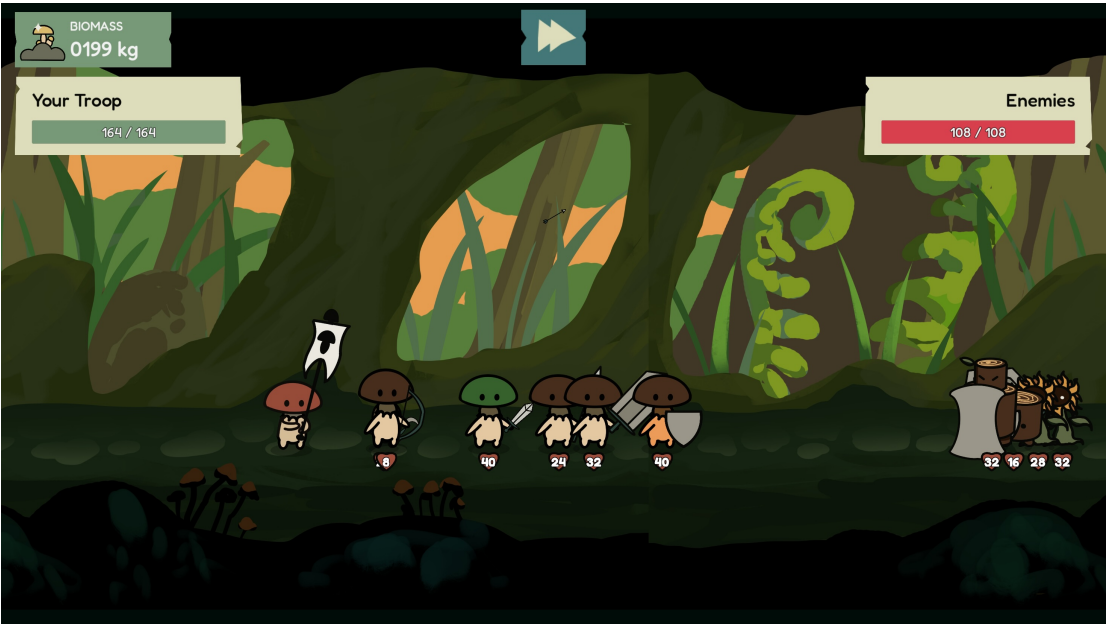


Choose which units will take part in battle. Scout the next enemy army. Arrange your formation. Evolve child units into adults by using the training cocoons.



Phase 2 – Battle

The troop fights in physics based 2D battles. During the fight you watch synergies, knockback, projectiles, and deaths. Win: **battle reward** in biomass. Lose: the run ends. Fallen adults can be replanted to keep their lineage going.



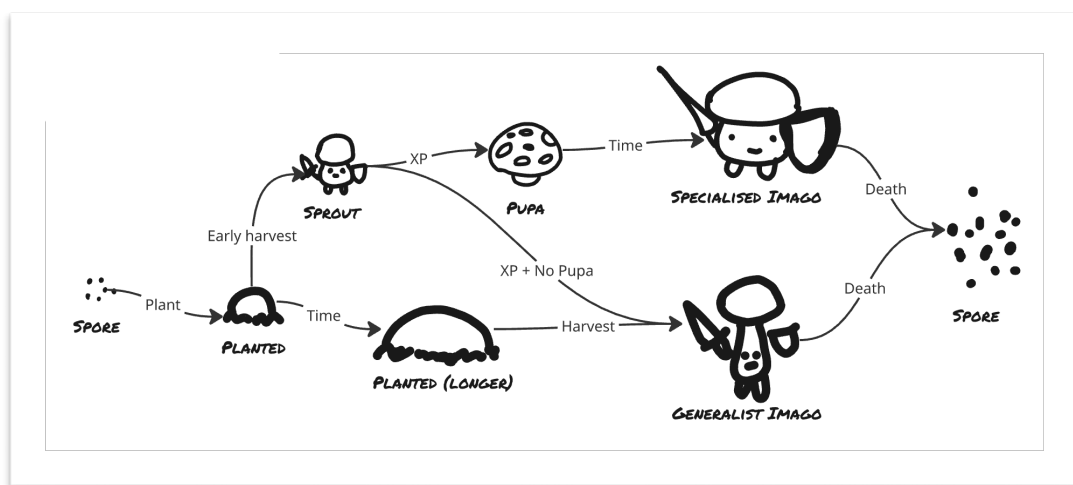
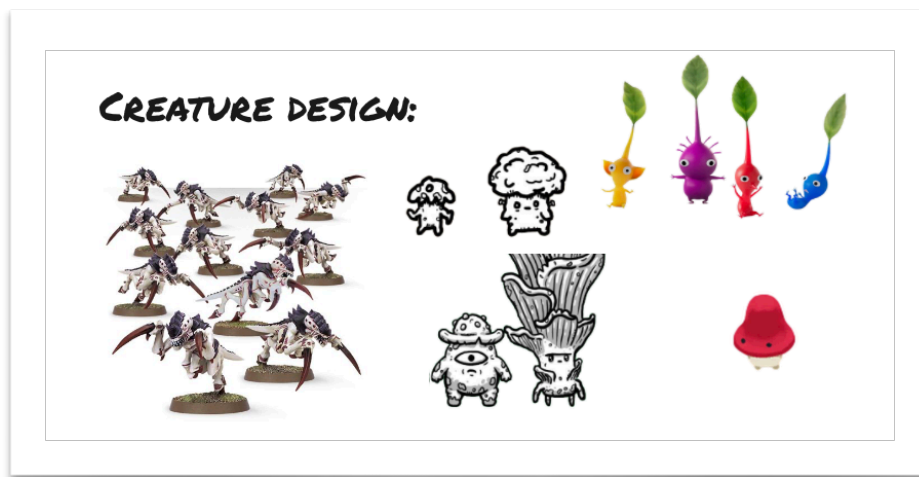
What makes the game fun?

Build variety and replayability. Ten in-game days are short enough to try a different build every evening. Mutations, fertilisers, seals, and weapon training multiply the number of options without .

Breeding powerful lineages. Composting and re-planting make up the metagame. Inherited trainings, weapon combos, and mutations feed the desire for “one more run.”

Physics fights that are fun to watch. Knockback, arcs, and collisions make a won (or lost) battle into an emergent story, not just numbers.

Cute creatures. Tiny mushrooms with a handmade look. Named units feed player attachment. Mutations add visual variety. Wacky mutations and fertilisers, child and adult distinction give rise to emergent narratives (e.g. I don't want to send children to battle!).



Early sketches of the concept



Use of funds

We intend to use the pre-production funds to **create a polished vertical slice of the game** and publish it as a demo on Steam.

Production quality

The funds will be used to create a more polished experience:

- **Art:** Most of the art is based on quick sketches. A lot of icons are placeholders. Mutations only affects colours. We plan on doing a game-wide second art pass to improve all that.
- **Audio:** Improve the sound effects, consider hiring a musician for the soundtrack.
- **Onboarding:** Create a custom first run to introduce the player to the game concepts
- **Balance:** Frequent playtests will help us balance the game and ensure that every build is viable.
- **Content:** Increase the amount of content in the game's systems: more fertilisers, mutations, seals, enemies, weapons.

Content Variety

Increase the amount of content in the game's systems: more fertilisers, mutations, seals, enemies, and weapons.

	Mutations	Fertilisers	Seals	Enemy types	Weapons
Prototype	11	17	17	10	15
Steam Demo	20	40	25	15 (3 bosses)	20

The Steam demo keeps this system but will expand on the number of content on all axes.

We would also like to have Monster Hunter-like bosses serving as the final gatekeepers for completing a run.

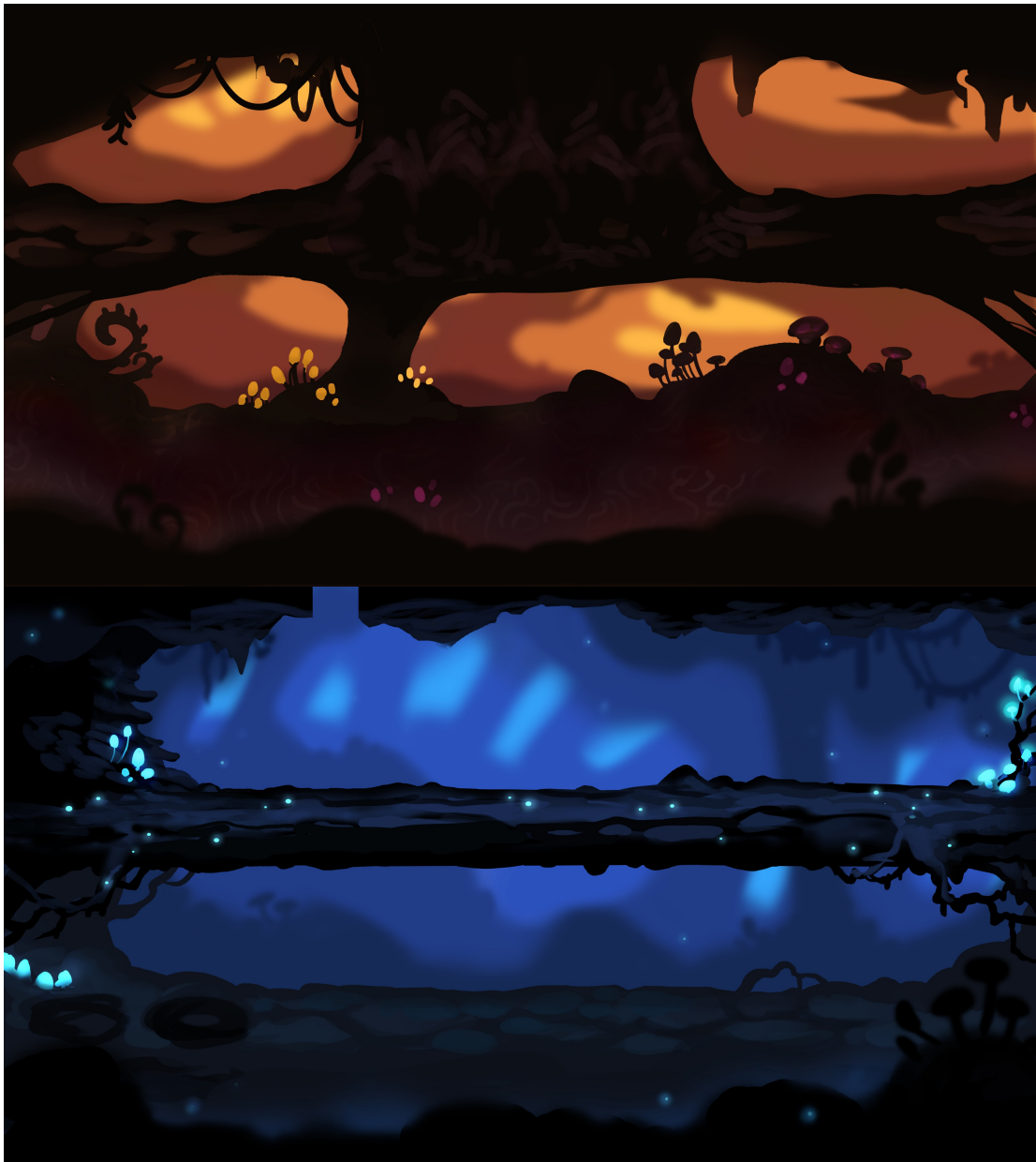


Tone and aesthetics

The setting is based on a post-apocalyptic version of earth where humanity has disappeared. Sentient mushrooms and plants have taken over and they're at war for the planet's biomass.

Despite the slightly darker premise, the characters lean into a cute design. Not enough, however, to qualify as a cozy game. The gloomier undercurrents of the setting remain present in the background of the game through certain game mechanics like composting, or the tight link between fungi and decomposition and rot.

The mushroom base takes inspiration from ant colonies in its organisation, and the army should convey the feeling of a hive. This is further reinforced by the sense of scale in the game communicated through backgrounds reminiscent of macro photography.



Inspirations



Pikmin

Scale, garden war, and the feeling that your units are small, and expendable. A cute design hiding some darker undercurrents in the world building.



Patapon

The feeling of controlling a tiny army. A similar physics-based combat system. Similar weapons.



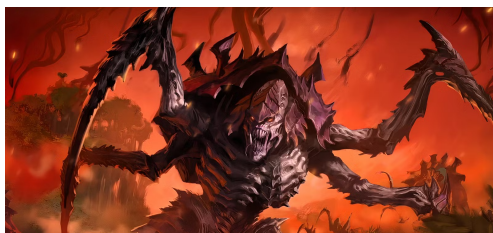
Hollow Knight

The hand-drawn 2D Art. The sense of controlling insect-sized characters. Backgrounds reminiscent of macro photography.



Tinyfolks

Train a handful of tiny people, upgrade between expeditions, keep the whole campaign bite-sized. Proof that "small units + town between fights + short session" can be a complete game. Its class system was a direct inspiration for our weapon training system.



Warhammer 40K

The Tyranids from the Warhammer 40K universe were a direct inspiration for the mushroom's lifecycle, and the focus on capturing biomass.

Marketing

During the Swiss Game Hub Bootcamp: the mentors emphasised two key drivers of market success for indie games: **genre selection & scope**.

- **Genre:** the game is first and foremost an auto-battler, a genre with many commercial successes in recent years. *Auto Shrooms* innovates on the usual formula by making you breed and grow your units instead of buying them. Despite not being an auto-battler, *Mewgenics* has proven that breeding can work as the main mechanical appeal of a game.
- **Scope:** Scope creep is where many indie games go to die. By focusing on replayability and build variety, auto-battlers naturally have limited scope. We aim to keep development time under one year.

Our long-marketing **plan** includes:

- **Influencer outreach:** By mid-September, the Swiss Game Hub will share the demo of the game with mid-sized Streamers and YouTubers for sponsored content. This will provide visibility in addition to valuable feedback to improve the demo.
- **Prototype on itch.io:** Releasing an early version of the game on itch.io to get early feedback and gauge interest. We plan on doing this in early September.
- **Mailing list:** the demo will be shared with our mailing list early, for gauging feedback before a fully public release.
- **Public Steam demo:** After the influencer outreach and the itch.io prototype, we will publish the demo on Steam. This will give us further validation and feedback to choose the direction of the project.
- **Steam Next Fest:** the demo will be showcased in the Steam Next Fest closest to launch (Summer 2027).
- **Social Media:** we will keep posting about the game throughout its development on social media (X, Reddit, TikTok). Short videos of the combat lend itself well to this format.



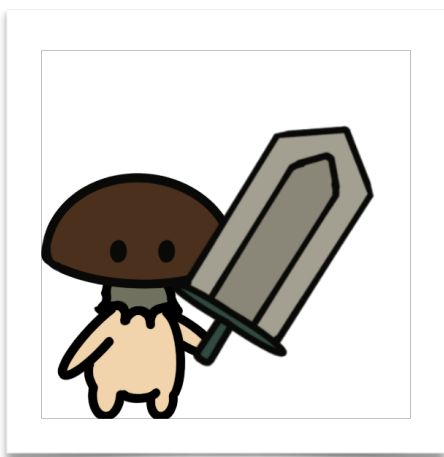
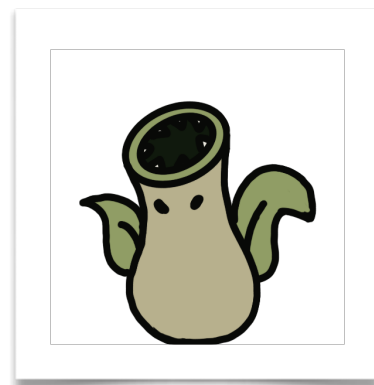
Target audience

We are targeting PC gamers who engage with indie games on Steam. Our core audience is not hardcore auto-battler fans, we're aiming for more casual enjoyers of the genre, including people that have never played auto-battler before. The design of the units could bring Pikmin and Patapon players for example.

We aim for a single run to take less than one hour, allowing for quick sessions even with a busy schedule.

The main motivations of player are:

- **Mastery:** seeing strategic decisions pay off, pulling off interesting new synergies and combos. Succeeding where they previously failed.
- **Tempting fate:** engaging with risky moves and getting away with it. Rerolling and getting exactly the item they needed.
- **Breedable cute creatures:** growing an army of tiny creatures, creating powerful lineages, mixing mutations.



Market analysis

Game	Release Date	Price Tag	Gross Revenue*	Units*	Reviews
<i>Dwarves: Glory, Death and Loot</i>	Jan 2026	\$14.99	\$2.7m	283.4k	2.6k
<i>Super Auto Pets</i>	Sep 2024	F2P	\$2.9m	3.8m	36.1k
<i>Backpack Battles</i>	Jun 2025	\$14.99	\$14.3m	1.5m	20.6k
<i>Batomon Showdown DEMO</i>	Sep 2026	TBA	N/A	N/A	544 (demo)
<i>Tinyfolks</i>	Jun 2022	\$3.99	\$128.6k	51.3k	1.1k
<i>PATAPON 1+2 REPLAY</i>	Jul 2025	\$29.99	\$3m	142k	2.3k
<i>Mewgenics</i>	Feb 2026	\$29.99	51.6m	2.2.m	53.2k

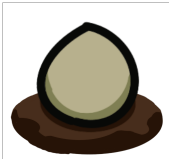
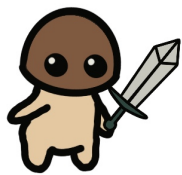
*estimates based on the numbers published by <https://gamalytic.com>

We believe there is strong indication that *AutoShrooms* has market potential:

- Auto battlers are a thriving genre on Steam with many recent successes.
- Mewgenics showed that breeding and creating lineages is a hook that works.
- Patapon demonstrated that there is an audience on Steam of players that enjoy cute tiny armies à la Pikmin



Roadmap

		
July – September 2026	October 2026 – March 2027	April – July 2027
Early Prototype Ideation and prototyping during the Bootcamp of the Swiss Game Hub.	Pre-Production Creating a vertical slice of the game. A polished 10 day run released as a demo on Steam.	Production Creating additional content: more fertilisers, mutations, enemies. Adding end of run bosses. Extending the run to 20 days. Localisation & Steam achievements.



CVs

Pedro Caldeira (Ingénieur Dipl. EPF)

Professional Experience	2025–now	Indie Game Developer at Cauldron Games. Released <i>wageslave</i> on steam
	2021–2024	Senior software engineer in the fintech space
	2019–2020	Freelance researcher/developer
Education	2011–2018	Bachelor & Master in Computer Science at EPFL
Personal Details	Name	Pedro Maria Caldeira
	Address	Obstgartenstrasse 36, 8006 Zürich
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	Email	pedro.caldeira@bluewin.ch
	Date of Birth	27.09.1992
	Nationality	Swiss–Portuguese

Stephanie Stutz

Professional Experience	2018–now	Digital Artist at Stray Fawn Studio (<i>The Wandering Village, Dungeon Crawler</i>)
	2016–now	Freelance 3D Artist–Illustrator
	2012–2015	2D–3D Artist at Vasp Datatecture GmbH
Education	2009–2012	Bachelor of Arts in Design at the Zurich University of the Arts
Personal Details	Name	Stephanie Stutz
	Address	Tüffenwies 27, 8064 Zürich
	Phone	+41 76 560 33 26
	Email	stephanie.stutz.work@gmail.com
	Date of Birth	05.08.1988
	Nationality	Swiss



Budget

All salaries, costs and the budget are calculated for the whole duration of the project.

Overview

Income / expense	CHF	Notes
Sales	105,000	15,000 units at CHF 14 includes Steam cut and taxes (-50%)
Own contributions	20,000	Private investment Pedro Caldeira
Pro Helvetia pre-production grant	20,000	
Salaries	-55,200	See table "salaries"
Non-personnel	-8,000	See table "non-personnel costs"
Blobfish admin	-1,000	Studio hosting
Balance	80,800	

Salaries

Person	Level	Months	Monthly at 100% (CHF)	Salary (CHF)	Social* (20%)	Total cost (CHF)
Pedro Caldeira	100%	8	5,000	40,000	8,000	48,000
Stephanie Stutz	20%	6	5,000	6,000	1,200	7,200
Total				46,000	9,200	55,200

* AHV/IV, BVG, Insurance. Estimated as 20% of salary.

Non-personnel costs

Item	CHF
Music and sound design budget	3,000
Office Space	1,500
Marketing Budget	1,500
Miscellaneous	2,000
Total	8,000

